

STAGE FOUR • MINDSET, PRODUCTIVITY & HABITS

FIRSTS

ICEBREAKERS / OPENERS

Short, stage-themed warm-ups tied to what each session actually covers

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Icebreakers / Openers

Stage Four • Mindset, Productivity & Habits

PURPOSE

Stage Four runs across three sessions: Mindset Foundations, Sustaining Systems, and Extra Edge / Standout Factor. Each gets one icebreaker, built directly from that session's actual content rather than a generic warm-up.

These openers work by confession and humor rather than performance — admitting a reactive morning, a graveyard of abandoned habits, an unmentioned hobby. That's deliberate: mindset and productivity content lands better once the room has already admitted, lightly and safely, that everyone struggles with exactly this.

Each includes the instructions to read to the group, a time estimate, and a short note on why it's specifically the right opener for what comes next.

Three Openers, One Per Session

SESSION 1

The Reactive Morning Confession

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask everyone to silently think of what they actually did in the first 15 minutes after waking up today (phone scrolling counts, be honest).
2. In pairs, share it, no judgment. Then guess: was it something you chose deliberately, or something that just happened to you?
3. Quick show of hands: who would genuinely be embarrassed if their morning routine were projected on a screen right now?

WHY THIS WORKS

This surfaces, with humor rather than shame, exactly the reactive-morning problem that FIRST E2 (Morning Productivity Ritual) is about to address, making the exercise feel like a solution to something just admitted rather than an abstract assignment.

SESSION 2

The Abandoned Habit Graveyard

TIME: 10 min

1. Ask each participant to name one habit they've genuinely tried to build and abandoned within two weeks (a gym routine, a journaling app, a reading goal).
2. Go around quickly, one habit each, no elaboration.
3. Facilitator asks the group: what's the most common reason habits die this fast? Collect 2-3 answers (usually: too big, no trigger, no accountability).

WHY THIS WORKS

This primes the room for Habit Stacking (E14) and Accountability Partner (E12) by making the group's own real failure patterns visible before offering the fix, rather than presenting habit-building theory to a room that hasn't named its own track record yet.

SESSION 3

The Humble-Brag Swap

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask participants to think of one genuinely interesting thing they've done outside of class or work — a hobby, a small project, volunteer work, anything — that's never come up in a professional context.
2. In pairs, share it. Partner's job: guess what skill or quality it actually demonstrates professionally, even though it wasn't meant to.
3. One or two pairs share with the full group: what unexpected professional quality did your partner spot?

WHY THIS WORKS

This is a direct, lived preview of Stage Four's Extra Edge section — the whole point of a side project, volunteer work, or thought leadership is that genuine outside interests often carry real, transferable signal most people don't think to mention.